

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 341

By Southerland

A RESOLUTION to recognize Reverend Richard M. Long on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we should honor those individuals who have answered a divine call to the ministry and who have served with dedication, vigor, and enthusiasm to perform God's work for their congregations and their communities; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Richard M. Long of Brown Springs Baptist Church and Big Springs Baptist Church is one such venerable individual, who has inspired the faithful as a pastor for thirty-seven years; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Long will soon retire from the pulpit as an active pastor, having evinced an unwavering commitment of service to the people whose spiritual lives he has guided throughout his vibrant ministry; and

WHEREAS, a reception to honor Reverend Long's many years of devoted service will be held at Brown Springs Baptist Church in Mosheim on March 30, 2025, from 2:00 pm to 5:00 pm; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Richard M. Long has demonstrated excellence in his calling as a man of God, and the members of his congregations are proud to call him their pastor, leader, and friend; and

WHEREAS, a true shepherd of the flock, Reverend Long has an abiding love for the ministry; his many positive contributions to his church, his community, and this State are deeply appreciated, and it is wholly fitting that he be recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Reverend Richard M. Long on the occasion of his retirement, thank him for his faithful service as pastor of Brown

Springs Baptist Church and Big Springs Baptist Church, and extend to him our warmest wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.